

State of the Practice for Research Software Survey

When you submit this form, it will not automatically collect your details like name and email address unless you provide it yourself.

* Required

Part 1 — Online survey consent



The purpose of this study is to conduct a current state of the practice analysis of software in select research software domains for the purpose of understanding quality and assisting in the future development of such software.

Study procedures

This survey will take about 30 minutes. The questions are about research software development, including obstacles you encountered while developing the software, and about the development process. Your answers will be temporarily recorded and securely saved on Microsoft Teams. The data will be retained for 3 years after the study and then deleted.

Risks

The risks have been described in the letter of consent that you received. To review, there are no physical risks, there is little psychological risk. You may feel that your work is being scrutinized. We assure that our questions are objective and technical, and do not suggest a course of action. The social risk associated with this survey is minimal. We will keep your identity private. However, maintaining the privacy of participants if they are sole developers, or members from a small developer team, may not be possible since their identities can potentially be inferred. The participant will have to accept this risk if they choose to participate. All personal information will be stored securely on password protected email accounts on password protected computers. You do not need to answer questions that make you feel uncomfortable or that you do not want to answer, and you can withdraw at any time. After the survey all that would be required to withdraw your answers would be an e-mail to smiths@mcmaster.ca stating which software project should have its data deleted. You can withdraw up until we analyze all data of this research project on August 30th, 2026.

Information that could identify you will not be published or shared beyond the research team unless we have your permission.

Benefits

The answers to these survey questions will help us analyze the current state of practice of software development, and provide insight into common or best practices for the benefit of future software development. However, participants may not benefit from participating in the study.

Voluntary participation

- Your participation in this study is voluntary.- You can decide to stop at any time, even part-way through the survey for whatever reason, or up until August 30th, 2026. Please let us know by email (smiths@mcmaster.ca) if you would like to stop.
- If you decide to stop participating, there will be no consequences to you.
- If you decide to stop we will ask you how you would like us to handle the data collected up to that point.
- This could include returning it to you, destroying it or using the data collected up to that point.
- If you do not want to answer some of the questions you do not have to, but you can still be in the study.
- If you have any questions about this study or would like more information you can call or email Dr. Smith, at 1-905-525-9140 X27929 or smiths@mcmaster.ca

This study has been reviewed by the McMaster Research Ethics Board and received ethics clearance under project 8215. If you have concerns or questions about your rights as a participant or about the way the study is conducted, please contact McMaster Research Ethics Office by phone: (905) 525-9140 ext. 23142 or e-mail: mreb@mcmaster.ca.

We would be pleased to send you the study results when they are complete. Please let us know if you would like a summary (last survey question).

1. Do you agree to participate in this proposed online survey and continue to the survey questions, knowing that you may skip questions or stop at any time without consequences? * 

☐ Yes, I agree and wish to continue

☐ No, I do not agree

Never give out your password. [Report abuse](#)



This content is created by the owner of the form. The data you submit will be sent to the form owner. Microsoft is not responsible for the privacy or security practices of its customers, including those of this form owner. Never give out your password.

Microsoft Forms | AI-Powered surveys, quizzes and polls [Create my own form](#)

The owner of this form has not provided a privacy statement as to how they will use your response data. Do not provide personal or sensitive information. | [Terms of use](#)